in the size of business enterprises and also lead to increase in the volume of office work.

1.3. Importance of Offices:

An office is an important unit of the whole organization which is also regarded as the mainspring of a watch. It has its equal importance in the government sector as well as in the private sector. It is essential for the office to perform a number of administrative as well as clerical functions in the process of achieving the organizational objectives.

Do You Know?

- The first modern business offices were those of London's Royal Navy built in 1726 and the East India Trading Company built in 1729 by Britishers to manage overseas operation.
- The invention of the elevator in 1852 saw the exploration of tall-building design.
- Home Insurance Building in Chicago, Illinois– considered to be the first skyscraper office building.
- In 1968, Robert Probst designed the "cubical", still widespread in the United States, which was followed by the now famous open space.
- Though Europeans referred to "Mad Men"-style offices as American plan, it was actually two German brothers who dreamed up the first open-plan office. They called Bürolandschaft, or "office landscape."

The importance of office can be explained with the help of the following point:

(a) **Information Center:** The office serves as an information centre. It collects information from sources like invoices, letters, memos, agreements, vouchers etc., and protects them in safe mode on the basis of their importance for future reference.

(b) **Proof of Existence:** The office is the evidence for existence and survival of business. As office coordinates the functions of different departments of an organisation, without office no business house can survive. People tent to generalize about the existence of business only with the help of regular functioning of an office.

(c) **Channel of Communication:** The office is the channel of communication between different people and department of business. The staffs working at various levels of managerial hierarchy are linked with one another through office. Office transmits the information about the functioning of different departments such as personnel, finance, production and marketing with each other.

(d) **Co-Ordination of Work:** Business is divided into department and sub-units for bringing simplicity in the operation. The office will work as a coordinator to maintain the relationship between departments. It develops productivity relationship to achieve common goals of an organisation.

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